BUSINESS & ECONOMY
Entrepreneurship

ELECTRIC DREAMS: The little chip in a giant ambition. The tough journey to *Atmanirbharta*

CHASING THE INDIAN DREAM

It's not always that a billionaire-industrialist heaps praises on the government of the day. "I have been living abroad for 27 years, and I have never seen myself in such a good position before," said Anil Agarwal, chairman, Vedanta Resources Ltd, at the India Today Conclave. Citing that today India is ahead of the world in areas such as renewable energy, electronics and semiconductors, the 69-year-old mining baron thanked Prime Minister Narendra Modi and his government for putting the country on the map among other economic superpowers. To highlight the new India's pace of growth, a cheerful Agarwal sang 'Chhodo kal ki baatein' from the Bollywood movie *Hum Hindustani*. "How can we take India to the first world? We have the capability here, we have traders, we have entrepreneurship, we have the passion to take risks," he said. "Today, the government understands this." ■

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- India is the only country that moves forward with its family. This will be a big reason why it will become the next America
- There is no problem in our governance. Keep moving forward
- Money comes and goes, but those who have the desire to achieve something are needed
- Vedanta is keen to make India a semiconductor hub, has signed MoUs with 100 Japanese companies to achieve this dream

ANIL AGARWAL
Chairman, Vedanta Resources Ltd

I never had the desire to earn money in my heart... I always had the desire to do something different, and whatever work I did, it came with so many difficulties

Today, Vedanta is the world's largest aluminium producer. When you move forward, God walks with you. There are no calculations there



Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH